



Game Design Document for:

Ojiisan no Origami

(Grandfathers' Origami)

A Master's adventure unfolds



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Version # 1.00

Wednesday, February 24, 2010
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Design History

Version 1.00 – Initial Pass at GDD

- Loaded up header/footer information
- Populated title page
- Copy/pasted over information from Concept Document
- Populating sections with deliverables and templates specific to the project

Version 1.01 – Slicing up the doc

- Harold – Feature Set/Feature Details/Gameplay Details
- Neil – Gameplay Walkthrough/Audio
- Alex – Game World/Cinema Appendices
- Cisco – UI/Game Interface Wireframes/HUD
- Gord – Characters/Enemies & Obstacles (Puzzles)/Story Appendices

Version 1.02 – Compiling the doc

- Compiling all the different sections together
- Formatting

Game Overview

High Concept

Ojiisan no Origami (ONO) is an isometric platforming adventure in which the player controls a character that leads his grandson through environments by creating a variety of origami devices to escape harm and overcome obstacles. The player accomplishes this using the keyboard and mouse to utilize their learned abilities.

Philosophy

As a group, we wanted to create a game that had more to do with creation and discovery. From the outset, our mission statement was 'Creation, not destruction', and we strived to maintain that vision throughout the design process. Moving away from the 'easy route', we turned our talents towards a title with puzzle solving, creation, and a pleasing aesthetic design. We hope to follow through on our design philosophy, and 'stick to our guns' throughout the process.

Common Questions

What is the game?

The game is primarily a 3d isometric platformer with an overall goal of leading an NPC character through the environment to complete objectives and avoid harm, using both environmental navigation and origami shapes with different abilities.

What do I control/ Who Am I?

The player controls the spirit of a man who has come to reconnect with his grandson. The character model will resemble the man in origami form, scaled down so that the world around him is larger than normal.

What is the premise/story?

Sasuke Taro was 5 years old in 2003, when his parents were taken in an automobile accident. Taro was released into the care of his grandfather, Sasuke Atsuke, who lived with the family at the time. Each year, during the summer trimester break, Atsuke would take his grandson to Peace Memorial Park in Hiroshima to place a paper crane on the Children's Peace Monument.

In 2009, Atsuke passed away, and Taro was adopted by his aunt in North America. Transplanted to North America, Taro cannot visit Peace Memorial this July and he spends the summer with his cousins, adapting to the North American way of life, the English language, and the preparations he must make to enter school in September.

In Japan, the Obon festival takes place in August for 3 days; a festival in which the ancestors are said to revisit the household, and watch over their loved ones. During this time, Atsuke is determined to visit his grandson in North America and bring him one last paper crane before the Toro Nagashi festival, where lanterns are placed in the river and float downstream to signal the return of the ancestors to their peace in the afterlife.

Taking on the role of Atsuke, the player will traverse environments to find his grandson, by using his knowledge of origami to create vessels for him to navigate the levels, and solve puzzles. Once he has found Taro, he will reunite with him one last time, and deliver himself as a paper crane, to be sent off during Toro Nagashi, so that he can remind his grandson of not only their shared personal traditions, but of the love of his people for peace and their hope for a peaceful world.

How many characters do I control?

You only control Atsuke, the main character, but your actions and choices indirectly control the movement and decisions of Taro, his grandson.

Where does the game take place?

The game takes place in the suburbs of North America – city streets, public parks, school playgrounds, and more.

What are the Goals/Objectives of the game?

The primary, long term objective of the game is to get Taro to remember and respect the lessons taught to him by his grandfather by leading him away from negative influences and luring him towards situations where Taro can perform a charitable action. Throughout the levels of play, mid-range goals will include completing all the available objectives within a level, and getting Taro from 'point A' to 'point B'. As a moment to moment goal, making sure that Taro stays out of trouble by successfully platforming through levels by using the available origami shapes.

What is the main focus?

The main focus of the game is to use your origami skills to make sure that your errant grandson stays out of trouble, and grows up to be a respectful man. Through achieving objectives laid out in each level (helping people, respecting his surroundings, etc.), and avoiding dangerous situations (smoking, throwing rocks at cars, etc.), Atsuke grows closer to his ultimate goal of getting Taro to observe the Toro Nagashi festival, and saying goodbye to his grandfather.

What's different?

Origami as a feature mechanic has not been successfully executed in gaming, and we would like to present it less as a simulation/teaching tool for the art, and more as an action feature. Using the origami also allows the player a degree of discovery, as they mix different folding styles to learn what folds allow for what objects.

In addition to the origami feature, presenting the player with a navigation adventure in the 'second person' is a similar experience to games like Ico and Lemmings. However, it is executed in a way that involves the player as a more direct influence to the environment, which is the draw to the child, as opposed to direct control.

Feature Set

Feature Highlights

Origami Building Events

Creating origami requires skill. Selecting your origami device is simple, but building it requires timing and reflexes. There is an Origami building event that tests the player's timing and memorization to create these shapes. This event transports the character into a 3d space in order to execute the folding sequence.

Problem solving using origami

The devices you create will not only allow you to explore the world and overcome physical obstacles; they will also be essential in solving puzzles in the environment, and achieving progression within the game. Creating origami requires resources though, so managing the amount of paper you have available will be key in this process. Origami paper will be rewarded to the player if they can find hidden caches throughout the levels; otherwise, they must ration their initial amount allotted at level start.

Objectives, Environment and Navigation

Though the player controls the movements of the grandfather in origami form, the grandson is the one doing the 'platforming', depending on the shapes the grandfather chooses to use to navigate the environment. Choose the 'correct' shapes to keep the grandson interested, while choosing the proper shapes to solve environmental puzzles as well. The key to victory is proper shape choice, balanced by managing your limited resources.

Visual style

Creating a fairytale story requires a fairytale atmosphere. However, our hero is moving around a modern-day environment, so we must take extra care to craft it in a way that creates wonder and excitement in such a setting.

Feature Details

Origami Building Events

This feature will be most prominent, as the player discovers the secrets to creating origami forms in the game engine, and how to properly use them in context to the task at hand.

Creation – the most integral part of this feature is the ability for the player to create. The method of creation will be as follows;

Discovery – the discovery process is a sub-set of the creation process. Through experimentation in the folding styles, the player will discover new origami forms to help accomplish their goals.

Usage – being that the game is completely contingent on the players' use of their origami selections, this will be a large detail section. In this, each origami form must be detailed as to what its' specific usage is, and what part of the environment it is specifically used for.

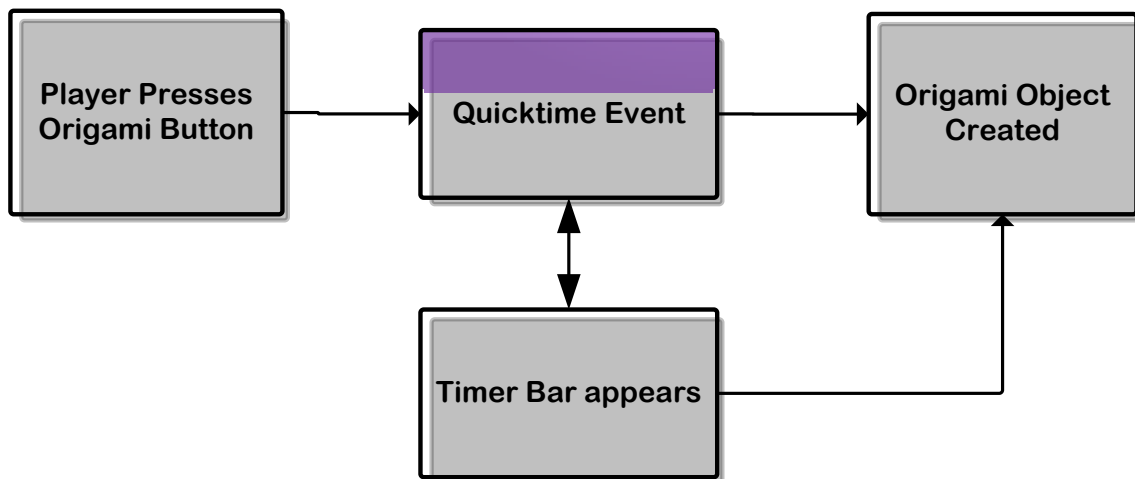


Figure 1 - Origami Mini Game Diagram

Problem Solving Using Origami

This section should describe the types of objectives that the player will have laid out before them (examples being helping the gentleman who has dropped his suitcase, feeding the ducks, avoiding smoking teens, etc.). As well, it should lay out the environment ‘types’ that the player will be interacting with, to give reference to the player in regards to the origami forms and their usages in these environments.

Objectives

Objectives are the mid-level goals set out for the player to achieve. These are the puzzles of the missions, and designed in a way to make the player think about what exactly they mean within the confines of the world, outside of the level goal of getting from point A to point B.

The Briefcase: In this mission, there is an older businessman who has dropped his briefcase, and is trying to scoop up all the papers that have fallen out. If the player can lead the boy towards this objective using a proper form, the boy will help clean up the papers.

To complete The Briefcase, the player will want to turn themselves into a form, and lead the boy over to the pile of papers that has fallen out of the briefcase, and deconstruct on the pile, which will lead the boy within proximity which will trigger the victory condition and animation of the boy helping out.

Obstacles

The obstacles encountered by the player will resolve around things that the grandfather (and most people, for that matter) would not want the boy to do. Activities such as throwing rocks at ducks, tipping over garbage cans, etc would be included here. There should be ways for the player to divert the boy from getting to these areas, including turning into a flower to make bushes grow and obstruct the way, turning into an origami ‘monster’ to scare the kids away before the player encounters them, altering the environment somehow.

Objectives, Environment and Navigation

Leash/Lead Missions
Escort Missions
Clear out the Path Missions

Glossary

GOOD ACTION – an action that requires the player (generally) to lead the boy into an event to complete and gain a ‘GOOD’ marker towards the players’ completion score

BAD ACTION – an event that the boy enters into that, if not acted against by the player, add one ‘BAD’ marker towards the players’ completion score

HELP POINT – is a physical point in the world that is highlighted by visual cue to indicate to the player that if they interact with that point, they can perform an action in the world to help the furtherance of their cause. Generally, these points instigate a quick paper folding event that results in them creating a set piece creation that performs a context-specific action

The Objectives and Missions should have aspects of them that are told through the choice of the player – if the player should choose to explore ahead a bit, they will find that there are solutions present that can be achieved if they have the time to execute them, but also, at times, there will be opportunities to perform a good action as well as try to divert from a bad action.

Smoking Kids vs. Man Drops Mail

In this event, there is a pair of kids smoking on the corner of a street. Across the street is a small, single storey grocer with a cloth awning in front. There is a 'help point' shining on the roof, and the player will be able to access this help point by creating a fairly simple form to access it (frog to jump to awning/point, then an event that creates a paper plane to knock the kids' sunglasses off and they take off).

However, if Taro gets too close to the kids, they will offer him a cigarette. At the time the kids pull out the cigarette pack, another help point appears on the package for a short time. If the player is able to interact with it and perform the required moves, they will change all the cigarettes in the package into a swarm of origami ants that will rush into the kid's clothing, at which point they will run away slapping their clothing and leaving Taro incredulous.

During all this, as well, a man walks crosswise near the player and Taro. When the man goes to drop the letter in a mailbox, it slides out and onto the pavement as he walks away. When Taro gets within X radius of the letter, it will become a help point for a short time. If executed correctly, Taro will go grab the letter, and drop it in the mailbox. This action will give the player some time to go ahead and scare away the smoking kids before Taro reaches them.

The Demonstrators

This obstacle features a line of demonstrators that are not allowing access to the next area in the game. In order to get the demonstrators to move, the player must travel into the middle of the crowd, and then interact with the help point, which will begin to turn the protesters' signs into origami forms that will fly away from them, leaving them to disperse and just hang around. This will allow Taro access to the next area.

Money Troubles

A gentleman is walking along, and has not noticed the hole in his back pocket that is letting his money fall out! In this situation, the player will follow the trail of money, instigating a quick (2 fold) event on each bill. Once 2 bills have been successfully completed, Taro will scoop up the cash and run to meet the man, returning the cash.

Newspaper Handouts

There is a newspaper box that the player can interact with. If they do, they turn the newspapers inside the box into giant origami crab claw that moves an obstacle out of the way. Likewise, this could be applied to a paper carrier with a bag of newspapers hanging from their hip.

Origami Blocks

This form acts differently from the others in that it actually creates an origami block in the environment that stays in the environment for a short time, which allows Atsuke to use it as a navigation tool, or as a physical block to stop access to certain areas.

Rhino does the Job

Player needs to activate a fire hydrant to stop traffic which will allow Taro to cross a busy street. Crossing the busy street will allow Taro's path to change, which will keep him from interacting with some 'bad kids' down the block. To prepare the path, the player must activate the form of a RHINO, and bash into a WRENCH attached to a nearby FIRE HYDRANT.

Once the player has successfully started the water flowing, traffic will stop moving down the street due to the blast of water that is now crashing across the street. This will allow Taro to safely cross the street without danger of being hit by cars, and divert him from the path of the 'bad kids'. In addition to this, a small stream of water will form in the street, which will allow Atsuke quicker passage down the street should the player choose the form of a BOAT to traverse it. Movement speed should be TRIPLED down the stream, to allow a very obvious advantage. This number can be tweaked during quality testing.

The Statue

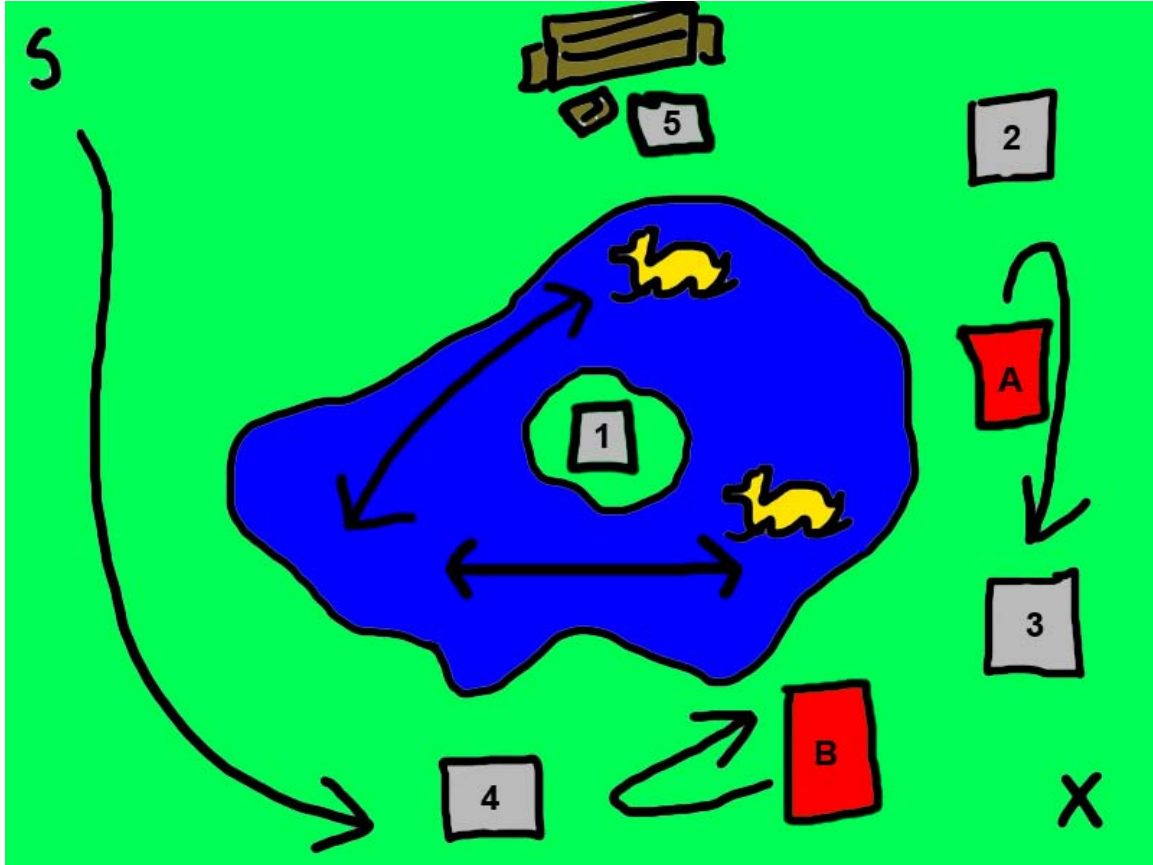
One of the set piece examples of a true challenge is the statue. In the final stage of the game, a pond lies in the centre of a city park. The statue should be somewhat reminiscent of the statue at Children's Peace Memorial in Hiroshima – a piece that represents triumph for Atsuke, should he succeed in his task. This statue should also be integral to the success of Atsuke in his final tasks, a necessity of motivation. The player will need to assume the form of a BOAT to travel to the island quickly. From there, the player must create a FROG to reach the top of the statue. Once atop the statue, the player will need to become a CRANE to successfully travel into the higher areas around the map, which will be just within reach, if they fly correctly. These higher places will be BIRDHOUSES, BEE HIVES, etc. Things which the player can use to try and divert the FINAL BAD KID, who will be traveling around the map in a seemingly RANDOM PATTERN. The things that Atsuke drops on or around the FINAL BAD KID will stop him from moving for X AMOUNT OF TIME (this can be tweaked during testing).

In addition to merely dropping things on the FINAL BAD KID, there should also be some means whereby Atsuke can achieve a GOOD ACT in this part of the game. That, as well, should be a moving target, but a benefit to the player, as it is a last attempt to do something GOOD in the game, achieving instead of just rolling along.

The GOOD/BAD should start at a fairly balanced, if not partial to GOOD level. Taro is, after all, a good boy at heart. The avoidance of BAD things is challenging, but performing GOOD acts should be rewarded as well.

The Final Challenge

A different take on 'The Statue', with an included diagram below



S = Player/Taro start point. The arrow leading from the start point is the standard path Taro will take to get to the end point of the mission.

1 = Statue on a small island in the centre of the pond. Reachable extremely quickly is the player assumes the form of a BOAT, or more slowly and methodically if they player assumes the form of a CRANE. The statue is a vantage point where the player will be required to become a CRANE to ascend, and may access points 2 and 4 from. These points are only accessible by ascending point 1.

2 = Squirrels have made their home in this tree. While the squirrels are in the tree, the player only has 1 second (TWEAKABLE IN PLAYTEST) to form into a new CRANE and start their flight to point 3 (point 3 is only accessible from point 2). While an experienced player may be able to do this, an inexperienced player will want to deal with the squirrel situation. This is achievable if the player character takes the form of a RHINO at the base of the tree and slams into it. This will knock all the acorns from the squirrels' home to the ground, and they will run down the tree to start pushing them back into a hole near the base of the tree. This will keep the squirrels busy for the rest of the mission.

3 = A beehive in a tree. Once the player has reached point 3, they must assume the form of a RHINO, and knock the beehive from the tree, if they wish to split the two groups of troublemaking kids. This will knock the beehive to the ground, creating a cloud of bees that neither group of kids will attempt to get past. To clear out the bees so that Taro may pass, the player must attract the ducks patrolling the south area of the pond by becoming a BOAT, and having the ducks chase them to the shore. The ducks will then come out of the water at the shore and start flapping around, splashing water, and scaring off the bees. The ducks will then return to the water, and the bees will disappear.

4 = The Birdhouse. The player is able to access the birdhouse by either Point 3 or Point 1. The birdhouse is home to a baby bird and mother. If the player chooses to access the birdhouse, the baby bird will emerge, and wait for the player to act. If the player chooses to go into CRANE form and interact with the baby bird, the baby bird will learn to fly, and will fly along the path of Taro. If Taro has not yet passed Point 4, the baby bird will entrance Taro for 10 seconds (TWEAKABLE IN PLAYTEST), allowing the player more time to setup other aspects of the level such as the bee hive, or trying to time the patrol path of the bad kids versus the walking path of Taro. The stop state of the boy may be interrupted by the LURE of the grandfather's sphere of influence. This effect can only be performed once.

5 = A chance for the player to move the ducks from the north end of the pond. If the ducks are not moved out, they will chase and harass the player in BOAT form, sinking them, and causing the grandfather to respawn on the north bank of the pond. The player must lure Taro to point 5, which is a bag of bread crumbs left by another old man. Taro will then pick up the bag, and start throwing bread crumbs on the shore. The ducks in the north end of the pond will leave the pond, and rush to the bread crumbs. This will afford the player 10 seconds of time (TWEAKABLE IN PLAYTEST) where the boy will be tied up doing something good, and the player may now access the water as a BOAT, speeding to the island in the centre.

Note that once the boy has performed this task once already, it will not be available to be done again. However, the player may then opt to become a RHINO and slam the box of bread crumbs over, which will draw the ducks out once again for another 10 seconds (TWEAKABLE IN PLAYTEST). This may be done once, and if it is done before the boy feeds the ducks, there will be no option for the player to lead the boy over to feed the ducks.

A = A single kid. If this kid bumps into Taro, he will try to get Taro to throw rocks at the ducks in the pond. The player will get the chance to stop this when the kid turns around, and a comic book is shown in his back pocket. At this point, the player may activate an event that turns the comic into an origami hand that climbs up the boys' back, and sends him yelling from the scene.

B = A group of two kids. If Taro gets caught up with the two kids, they will try to shake the birdhouse until the mother bird and baby bird fly away. On the first shake, a newspaper falls from the nest, and is then available to activate. If done in time (before Taro starts in), the paper turns into a big paper bird that flies after the two kids, scaring them off, and getting them away from Taro.

Visual Style

Drawing from the visual styles of Miyazaki films, Clover Studios games (Viewtiful Joe, Okami) and a soft colour palette, we hope to transform everyday life in the ordinary world into a call to adventure in a fantastic storybook setting.

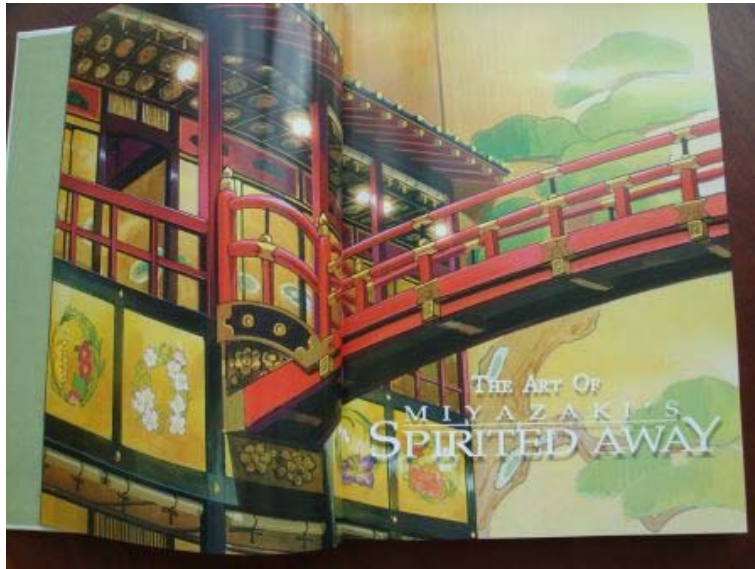


Figure 2 - Miyazaki's "Spirited Away"

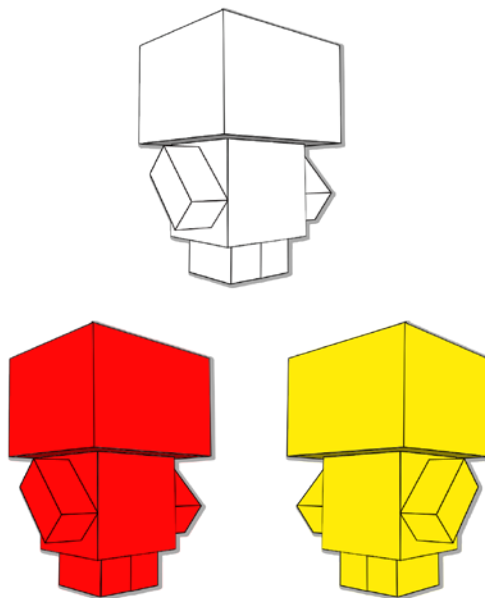


Figure 3 - Human Figure Models

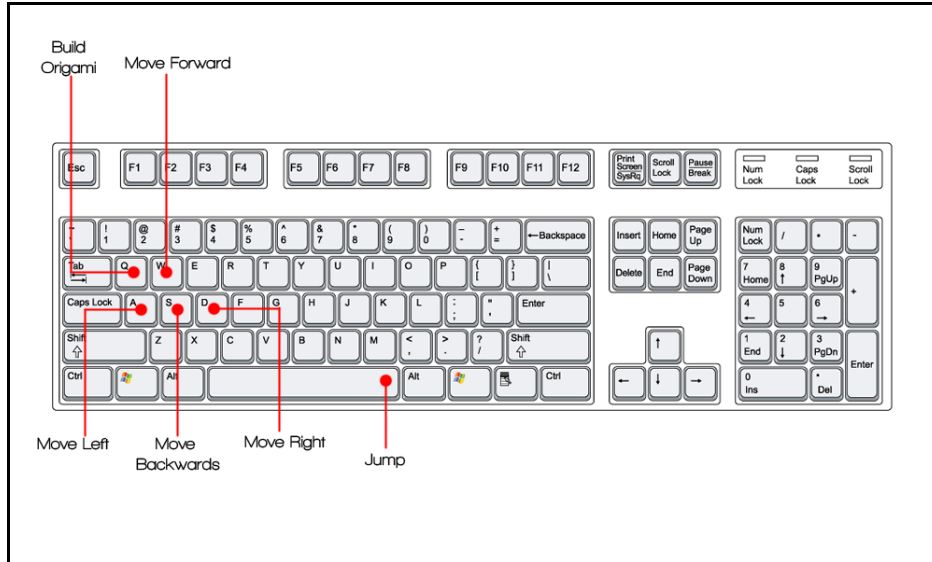
Gameplay Details

Movement & Navigation

- The character moves at an arbitrary speed of 1 unit per second. All variations of speed based on other origami will be a ratio compared with this number.

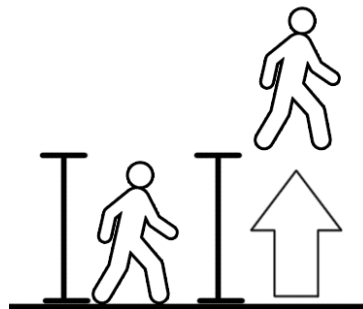


- The character's movement speed is almost always constant. There is only a run speed (at 1 game unit per second) and no walk. In order for animations to make the character movement seem smooth, there will be a tween animation between run & stop and vice versa. This animation must be short and concise to give the player a feeling of total control.
- The control schematic will be mapped onto a keyboard using the standard 'W', 'A', 'S', 'D' theme.

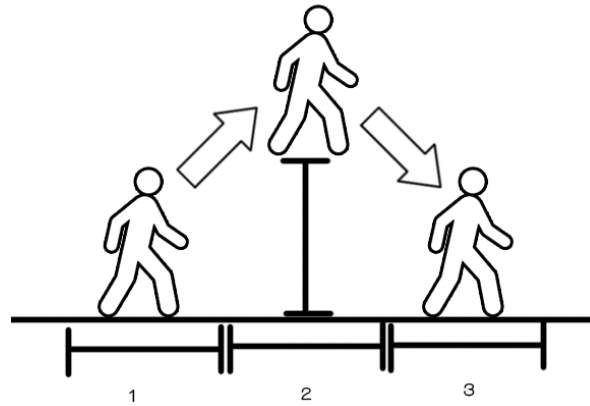


This is an example of the keyboard layout for the character in the platforming environment.

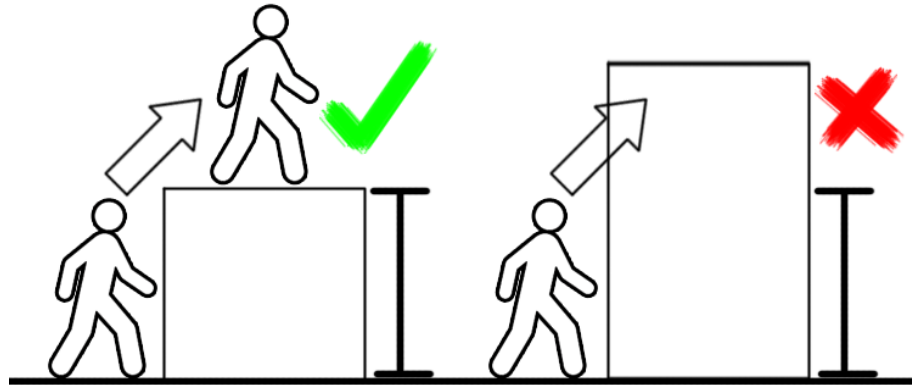
- Jumping in a platformer is extremely important. This mechanic must be considered extremely important as it is very relevant to the overall feel of the game. The character (without any aid of an origami shape) is able to jump one game unit high. He will remain in the air for two seconds before landing. The player is not able to hang off of a ledge if a ledge is 2 game units high.



Vertical Jump Height



Horizontal jump distance: Remains in air for 2 seconds, moving at a speed of 1 unit per second. The player can clear a gap of 1 game unit while in this form.



Players can jump on top of platforms 1 unit high or less in original form; but no higher.

Origami Shapes

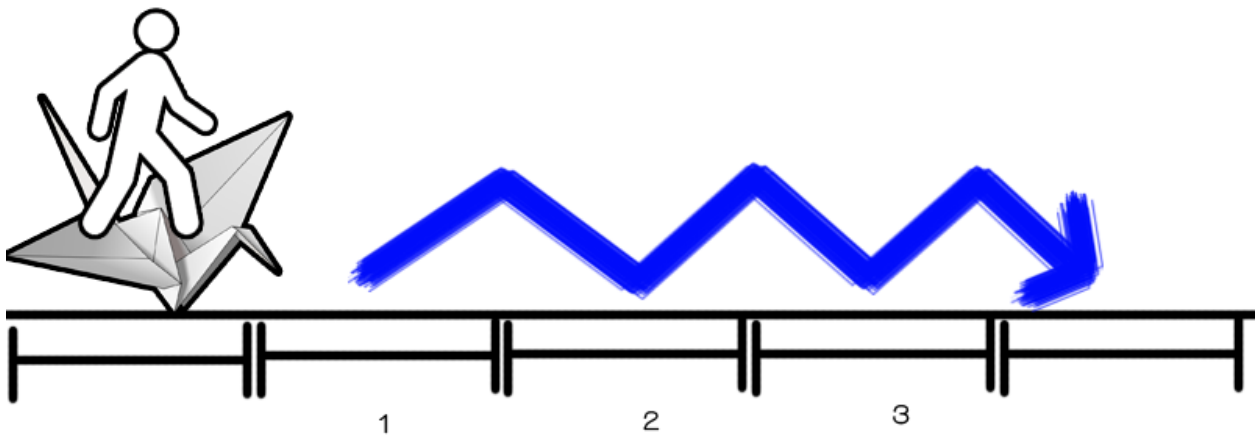
- Origami shapes give the player enhanced movement abilities or abilities to affect the environment around them
- The game will have a Crane, a Boat, a Frog and a Rhino
- Shapes will last a set duration of time; this depends on the quality of the shape which is earned by completing the origami folding event more accurately (Please refer to Feature Details – Origami Folding Event)
- If the player is already using an origami shape, the player can simply activate the origami folding sequence again in order to break out of the previous shape and fold one anew

- Shapes require a specific folding pattern to execute; performing a wrong sequence of folds will yield a useless shape that cannot be utilized by the player
- After a shape is created, a player is automatically set on top of the shape
- If any of the origami are damaged by environmental objects, they will break and transform the character back to his default form

Crane

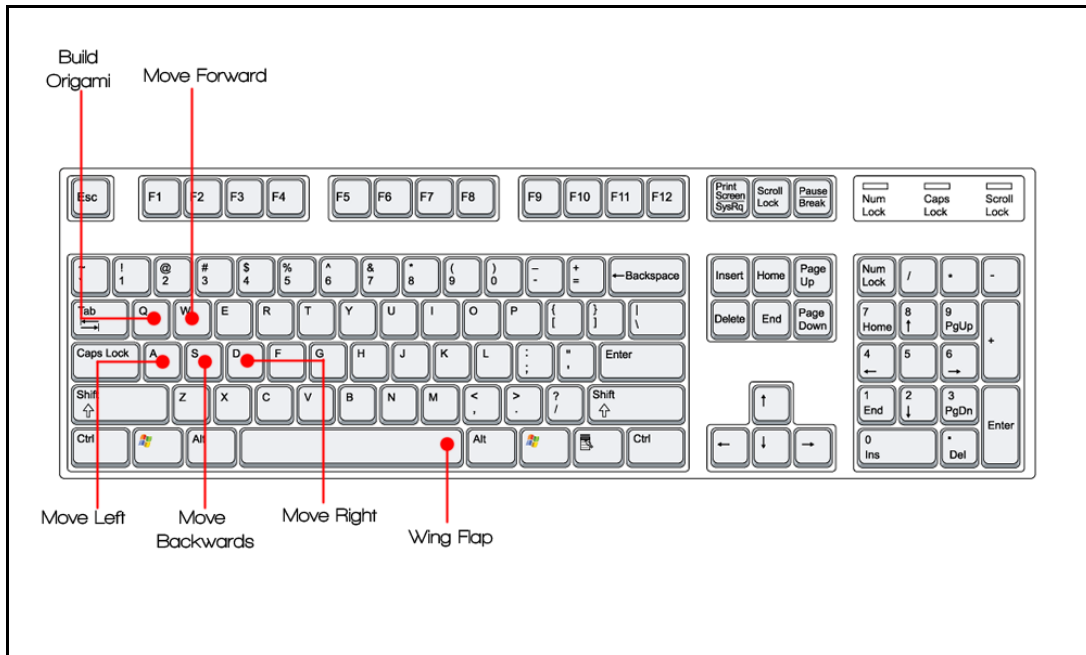
Allows the character to float over a large gap

- Cranes allow players to float over gaps that the character would not be able to cross normally
- Cranes can float over 3 game units as opposed to the normal character's single game unit jump



Crane is able to clear 3 game units in the air before having to land on a platform

- Air Control: While the crane is in flight, the player is able to change directions as easily as he could in default form
- The crane can also stop mid-flight; it is not necessary to travel the full 4 units while flying
- Each time the player wants to hover an extra unit, he would have to hit spacebar an additional time to flap the crane's wings (to a maximum of 3 consecutive wing flaps)

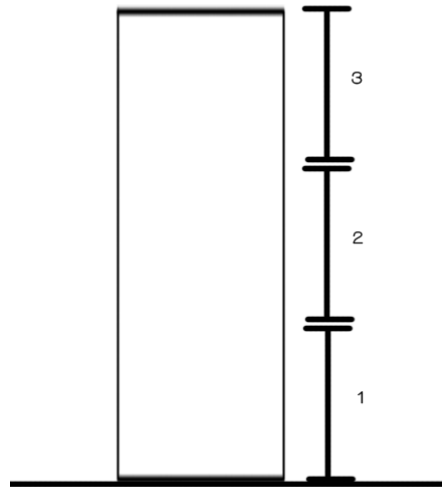


This is the keyboard layout for the Crane model

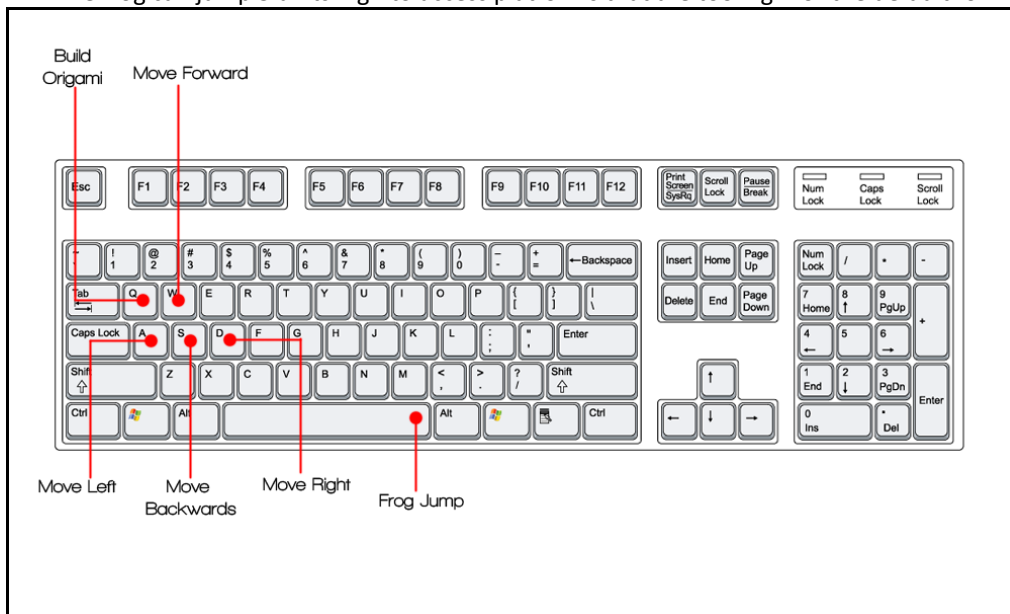
Frog

The frog allows the player to jump to different elevations that cannot be reached in default form

- The frog jumps up to 3 vertical game units high
- The movement speed of the frog is at 2 game units per second – faster than the movement speed of the default form



The frog can jump 3 units high to access platforms that are too high for the default form to get to



Keyboard Mapping for the Frog shape

Boat

Folding a boat allows the player to travel over bodies of water

- The movement speed of the boat is 1 game unit per second (same as default form)
- Certain bodies of water with a current (ie. stream of water formed from a broken fire hydrant) will force the player in a particular direction



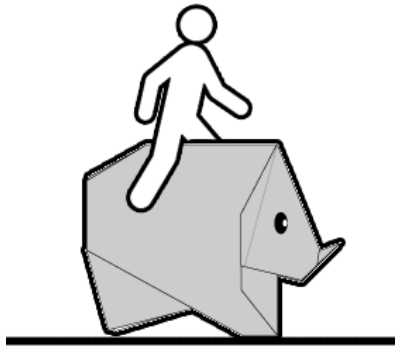
Size of the boat relative to the player's character

- The boat cannot jump and has no other ability other than being able to float on water
- If the boat is created away from any water, then it becomes a useless shape
 - o The furthest a player can be to create a boat would be 3 game units away from a body of water
 - o When the boat is created on water, the player is automatically on the boat
- The keyboard map for the boat is the same as the default form minus the jump ability

Rhino

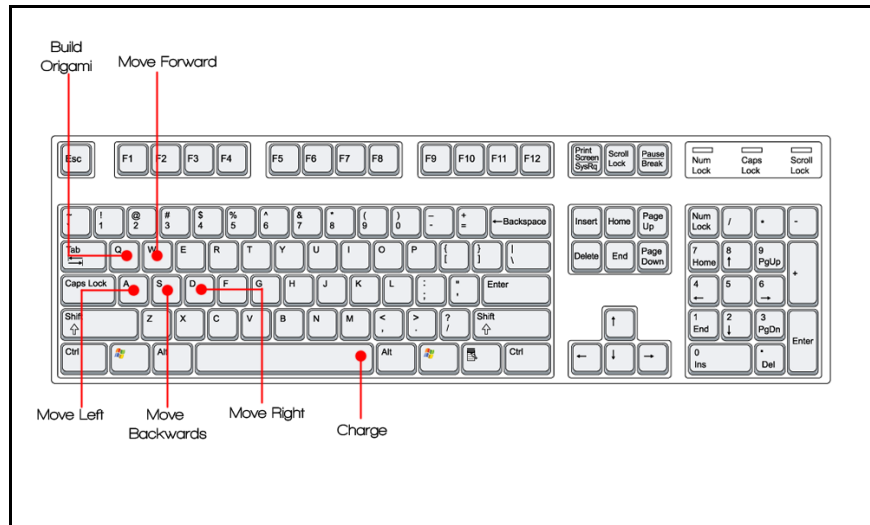
The Rhino allows players to push or knock over interactive objects in the game environment

- The rhino moves at a base movement speed of 1 game unit per second
- This shape has a charge ability: this ability is how the rhino shape is able to push or knock over objects
 - When charge is activated, the rhino increases speed to 3 game units per second but cannot change direction
 - Charge has a duration of 2 seconds – so charge travels 6 game units in total



The character riding on the rhino

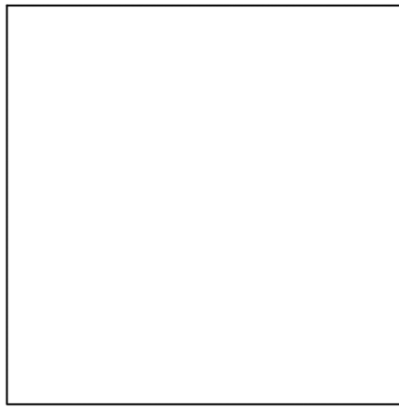
- The hit box for the rhino's charge is half a game unit around his horn
- The rhino has no jump ability



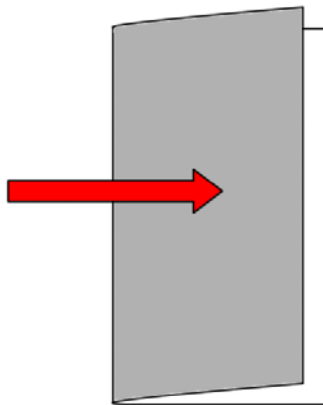
Key mapping for the rhino shape

How To Fold Origami

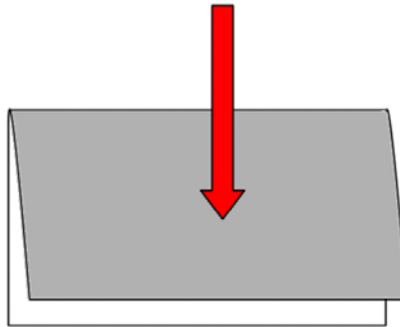
- In order to fold origami, the player must activate the origami folding event button while in the platforming world
- Each origami shape has 3 steps to completion
- The player always starts from the base origami paper



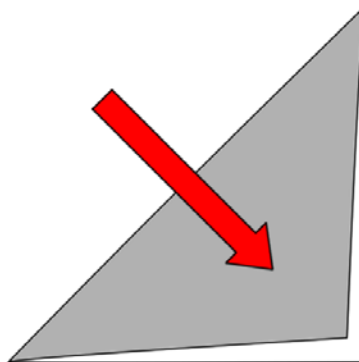
- There are 4 different types of folds:
 - Book Fold:



o Mountain Fold:

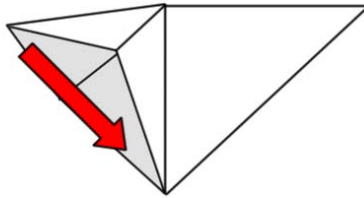


o Triangle Fold:

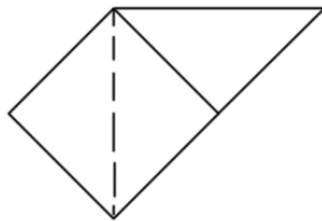


o Squash Fold:

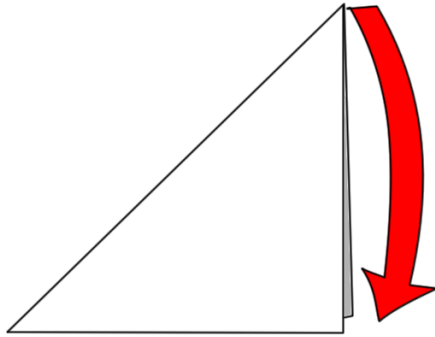
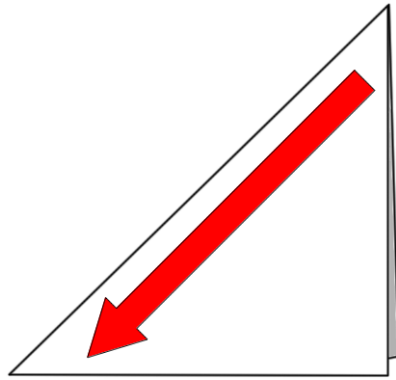
▪ Step 1



▪ Step 2

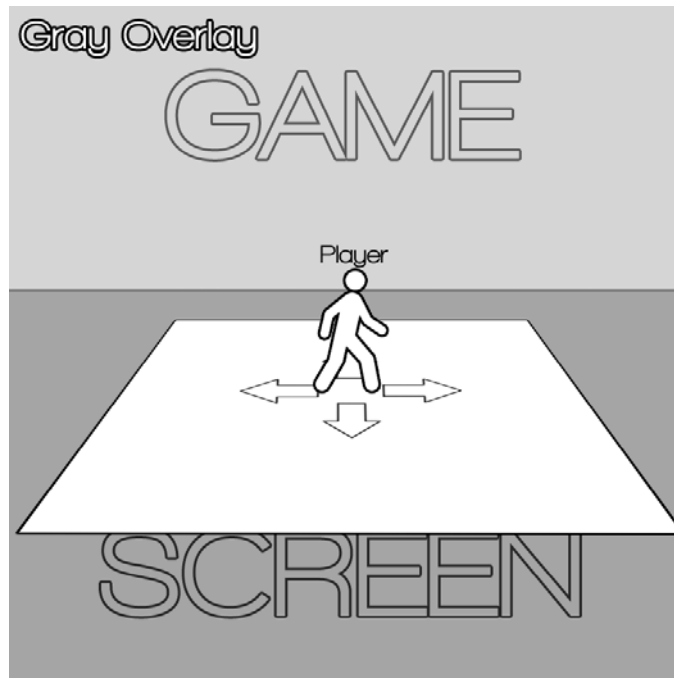


The difference between a triangle fold and a squash fold

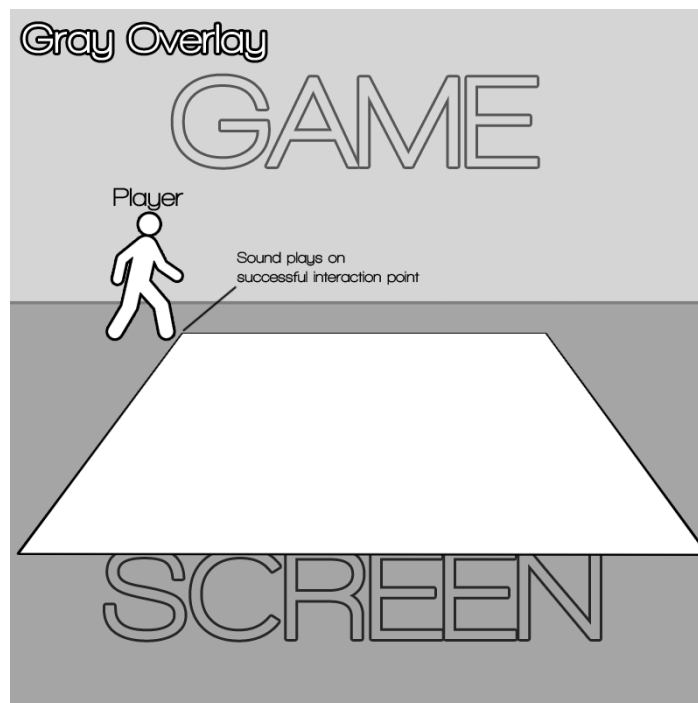


The difference between the execution of a triangle fold or a squash fold is the path the player takes after picking up a corner. The red arrows show the path the player must take in order to do a triangle fold (first image) and a squash fold (second image).

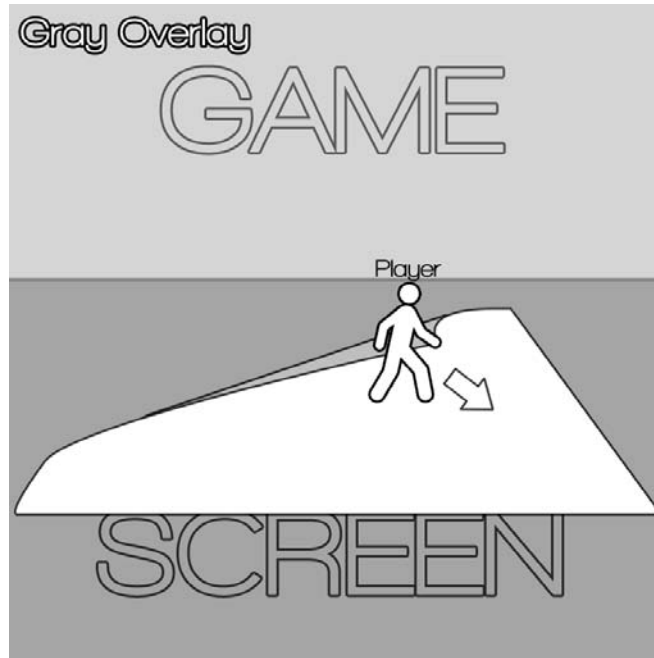
The way the player does the folds is via a mini game which is laid out this way:



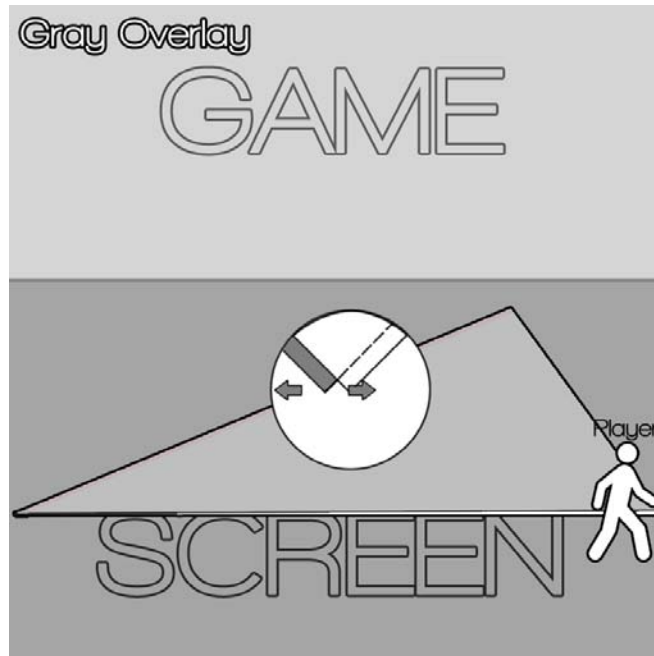
There is an overlay on top of the game screen of a piece of origami paper and the character stands atop this paper



The player navigates using W, A, S, D keys around this screen. Once he reaches an interaction point, the player presses 'Space bar'. If the position of the paper can be manipulated, there is an audio feedback for the player.

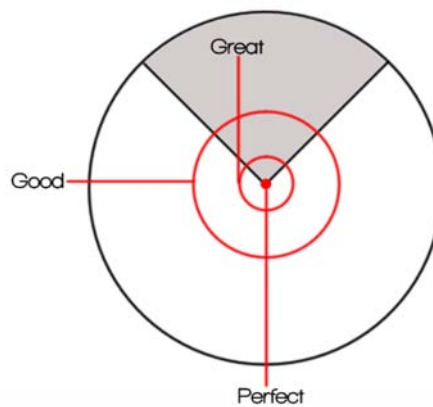


Once the paper is picked up, when the player moves the character around, the paper will be attached to the character's hand. The player is now tasked with moving this point to another point where it can be folded to.



When the player reaches the destination fold, he presses 'Spacebar' once again to lay down the fold. A quick-time event will appear with a piece of paper moving left and right at a gradually decreasing speed. The player must time this properly and press 'Spacebar' when the two sheets overlap each other perfectly to crease the paper. The quicker and more accurate the player completes this event will determine the grade of the fold.

- There are 4 different fold grades: Poor, Good, Great and Perfect
- There are 3 steps to folding each origami shape – each step is graded based on the accuracy and quickness
- Perfect – crease within the first 2 passes of the corners with 100% accuracy
- Great – crease within the first 3 passes of the corners with 90% accuracy
- Good – crease within the first 4 passes of the corners with 80% accuracy
- Poor – any crease worse than ‘Good’ – fail condition; does not create a shape



Accuracy zones for the quick-time creasing event

Bonuses for Different Grades of Folds

All Shapes

	GOOD	GREAT	PERFECT
DURATION (SEC)	7	8	9

Crane

	GOOD	GREAT	PERFECT
ABILITY	HOVERS 3 UNITS	HOVERS 4 UNITS	HOVERS 5 UNITS

Frog

	GOOD	GREAT	PERFECT
ABILITY	JUMPS 3 UNITS	JUMPS 4 UNITS	JUMPS 5 UNITS

Boat

	GOOD	GREAT	PERFECT
ABILITY	NA	NA	NA

Rhino

	GOOD	GREAT	PERFECT
ABILITY	CHARGES 3 UNITS	CHARGES 4 UNITS	CHARGES 5 UNITS

Gameplay Walkthrough

Overview

Ojiisan no Origami introduces the player to a surreal world shaped by paper and box styled objects. After playing a brief tutorial, the player takes upon the role of a grandfather that must find the best way to guide his grandson while in a ghost state. The ghost of the grandfather has the ability to transform paper into one of four origami forms. The player will lead the grandson away from threats within the dangerous environment. Clues will be placed within the environment to help the player make the best choices for guiding his grandson.

Accuracy in origami is the key to creating beautiful shapes. When the player changes origami forms, they must play a brief timed mini game. The mini game will judge speed and accuracy which will result in 4 different origami outcomes: Bad, Good, Great or Perfect.

Hours of Gameplay

We are planning to create a 5 to 10 minute game experience for an experienced player. For newer gamers, it may take up to 20 minutes to complete the level.

Victory Conditions

The player is successful if they are able to guide the grandson through the environment in the fastest time possible. If they take too long to complete the shape in the timed mini game or if they fail to achieve 70% accuracy on a crease on any step, the player will have to redo the sequence to change forms.

Cutscenes

Intro Cinematic



playground



**boy and grandfather
playing with origami**



grandfather



grandson



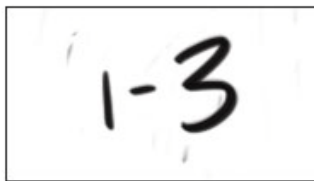
**grandson folding
origami**



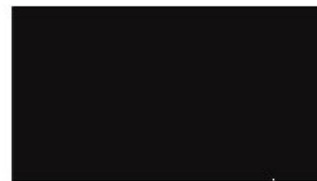
grandson



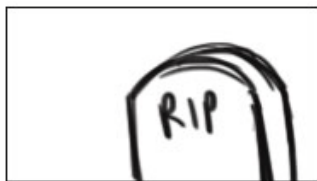
**close-up of his
first crane**



reuse 1-3



black screen



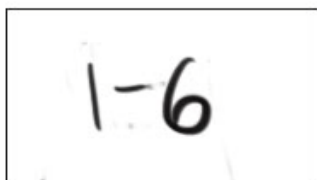
gravestone



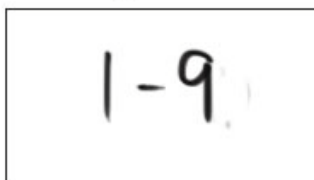
**grandson standing
over gravestone**



**grandson puts
crane down**



reuse 1-6



reuse 1-9



game starts

City Cinematic



**window in boy's
room**



**crane fly through
the window**



**crane fly through
the suburban**



crane fly to city



**crane fly over
the city**



**crane fly through
the city**



game starts



Park Cinematic



crane flying



fly into the park



fly through the trees



**fly over the
lake area**



game starts



Beat Chart

Beat Name	Area	Beat Type	Beat
Cinematic 001		Intro Cinematic	
Tutorial 001	Apartment	Movement and Controls	
Tutorial 002		Origami: Rhino	
Tutorial 003		Origami: Frog	
Tutorial 004		Origami: Boat	
Tutorial 005		Origami: Crane	
Cinematic 002	Suburban	Cutscene #1 Fly over the town	
Exploration 001		Navigation - Frog	
Puzzle 001		Man drops mail	
Exploration 002		Navigation - Rhino	
Exploration 003		Navigation - Crane	
Puzzle 002		Money troubles	
Exploration 004		Navigation - Rhino & Boat	
Exploration 005		Navigation - Frog & Rhino	
Puzzle 003		The Demonstrators	
Cinematic 003		Cutscene #2 Fly over park	
Exploration 006	The Park	Navigation - Crane & Boat	
Puzzle 004		The statue	
Puzzle 005		The Final Challenge	
Cinematic 004		Ending Cinematic	

Camera

The camera will be a 3rd-person, isometric style view. We want the player to be able to see their immediate surroundings and beyond, to allow them the forethought to solve the various puzzles in the environment.



Figure 4 - Screenshot, "Fat Princess"



Figure 5 - Screenshot, "Torchlight"

Game Characters

Sasuke Taro

Taro is a good boy at heart – his parents and grandfather all raised him to be. He is, however, finding North America moves at a very different pace from his home; a country where not only the values of his community are radically different from those he was raised under in his grandfathers' home town of Hikone, but also the lifestyle of his adoptive extended family. Having never lived in Japan, his cousins Mac and Justin are oblivious to the things that Taro reminisces on, and though his aunt pays lip service to his upbringing, she herself has not lived in Japan for a long, long time.

Time is a great divider - it has been almost a year now since Taro's grandfather Atsuke passed on, and he is coming up on his second year of school in North America. A fast learner, Taro has applied his time towards rapid learning of the English language and North American culture. Making fast friends in his cousins, Taro (now "Terry" to his friends) has begun to blend more with his surroundings. While this is a great deal easier on Taro, it has also opened him up to many of the things his friends at home would never dream of.

With their final year of elementary school on the horizon, Taro and his friends have started to discover what it means to be the 'big kids' in school. As an example to those younger than himself, Taro finds himself torn between maintaining his home upbringing, and falling into the cultural norms that make up being a pre-teen in North America – smoking, learning profanity, and other pitfalls that he knows his grandfather would not approve of.

Unfortunately, Taro's grandfather is not here, but his cousins are. Taro must now choose between being Taro, being Terry, or just being his own person, left to choose what is right for himself.

Sasuke Atsuke

Atsuke was not prepared to be a father again. However, fate has its' own necessities, and fate decreed guardianship of one last generation of young Sasuke male to Atsuke when his son and daughter-in-law were taken from him. Knowing that his son and his young wife would be relying on him, Atsuke took Taro in and they lived together under Atsukes' roof in Hikone.

Atsuke knew though that Taro would not be a boy forever, and he would one day need to learn what it was to be a man – respectful of the world and those who live in it, responsible for himself and his choices, and prepared to stand up for what was right, in the face of the many wrongs that the world holds.

But Taro was not yet a man, and did not have the responsibilities of a man. Being a young boy, he was determined to have fun, and Atsuke was often dragged along through many an adventure in the woods near his home only to return, dripping with creek water and brushing knots from Taro's hair that night. Though more rigorous than he was used to, Atsuke cherished these times he was now able to share with his grandson, for he was unable to spend these times with his own son, as he found himself locked into his own culture of long work hours, and very little time to himself.

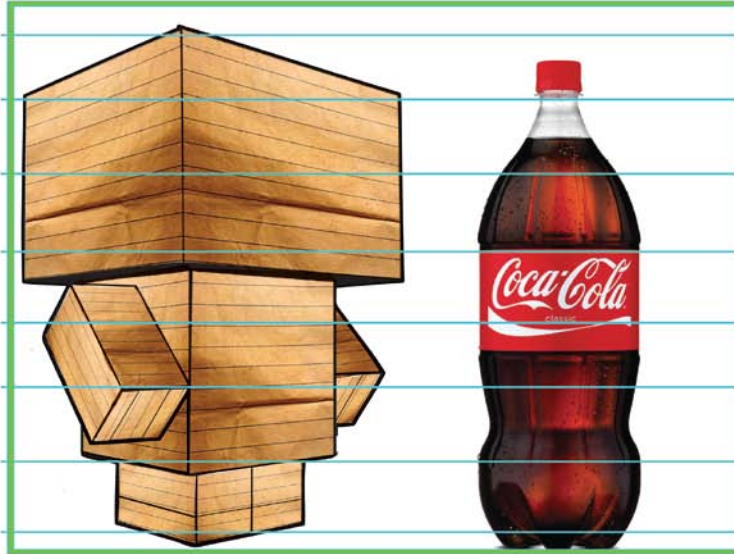
Able now to pass on some of himself, Atsuke began to teach Taro origami, and took him for yearly visits to Peace Memorial Park, where he taught Taro the story of Sadako Sasaki and why they placed a paper crane on the monument whenever they visited.

Time, however, is a great separator, and Atsuke knew as well that he had precious little of it left. Making contact with his daughter-in-law's sister Sandra, who left Japan as a child to live in North America, he made sure that Taro would be taken care of once he was no longer able to care for him.

Finally, in 2009, Atsuke went to be with his son. However, rest is a relative term, and Atsuke swore to maintain his promise to his son to assure the well-being of Taro. Forsaking eternity, Atsuke traveled long to be with Taro in North America, to teach him a few more lessons before moving on to his own peace.

Character Scale

CHARACTER REFERENCE



WORLD REFERENCE



The Game World

Overview

North America, from the ground up

The game takes place in a suburb of North America, in a fairly common neighbourhood. Small shops, rancher-style homes, and public parks. Unremarkable in life, but treacherous and not-easily navigable as a spirit inhabiting origami forms.

Objective-based environments

The world around you is filled with peril, both to yourself and your beloved grandson. However, there are also those in the world who could use a helping hand to get back on track for the day. Help them on your way from place to place, and reap the benefit of being able to provide better quality gifts for your grandson at the end of each level in the form of origami pieces to collect.

Obstacle-laced environments

Though the world may offer opportunities to the enterprising young man, it is also littered with lures and temptations. Help your grandson avoid these things, as they will no doubt change his outlook on the world, and his appreciation for the values you have tried so hard to teach him!

The World Layout

Overview

ONO consists of three main levels that the player can navigate through: the suburban area, downtown area and the park area. Player starts in the suburban area and work his/her way up to the park area. The level of puzzles difficulty increases as player progresses through the game.



Figure 1 Overview of the game levels.

Suburban Area – Tutorial (Easy)



This is where the player starts off in, ultimately his/her apartment. This is where player is first introduced to different types of origami available in the game.

The player starts off in a room, where he must navigate around the 3D room to find an origami book, and then he is presented with a series of tutorials that help the player familiarize himself/herself to the paper folding mechanics. This is the only part of the level that is indoor.

Here, player can explore his/her ability in origami folding without being pressure with time. As soon as the player learned how to fold all the different types of origami; crane, frog, boat and rhinoceros, he/she is presented with a quick cinematic introducing the rest of the levels.

Player gets the first taste of the neighborhood soon after the cinematic end. Graffiti on walls act as visual cues to the player to which direction they should be heading and also instructions of how to fold different origami shapes in case they forgot.

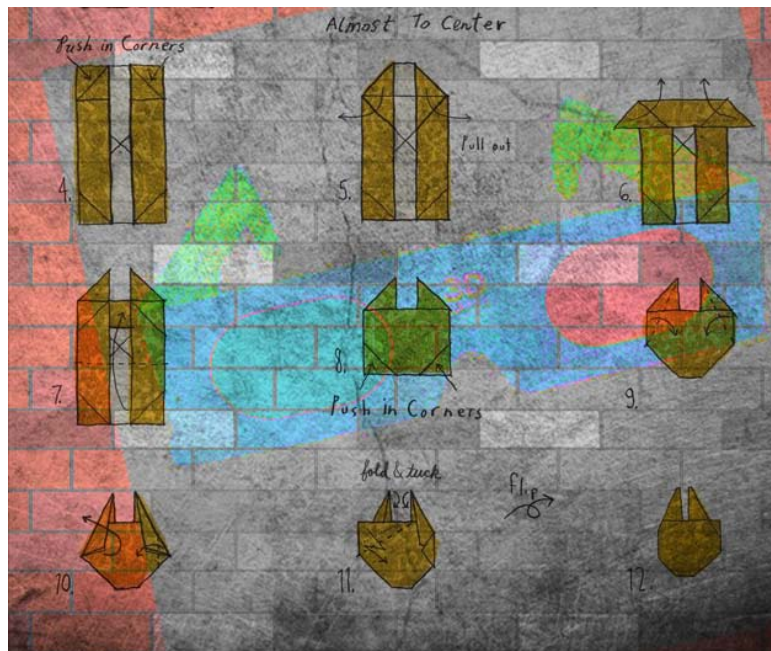


Fig 2. An example of Graffiti Origami instructions on the wall

Downtown – Mid Point (Moderate)

The Downtown area is where most of the core game play takes place. The player will be presented with a variety of minor puzzles as well as major events that is vital to the player.

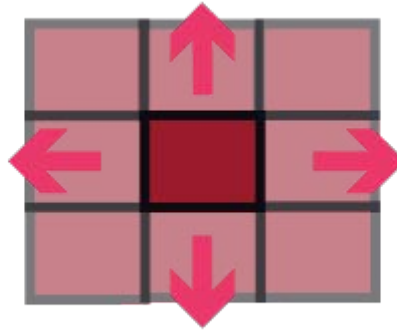
The Park – Ending (Hard Difficulty)

At this point of the game, the player would have already mastered the different folding techniques of Origami.

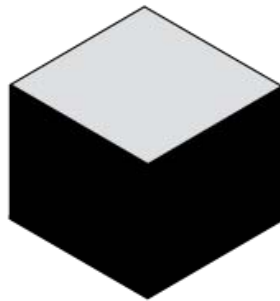
In this level the player will overcome one last obstacle before he/she can finish the game.

Objects

Objects that players can interact with are highlighted Red in the game world. The player can only interact with it by pushing the object in 4 different directions, it cannot be pulled.



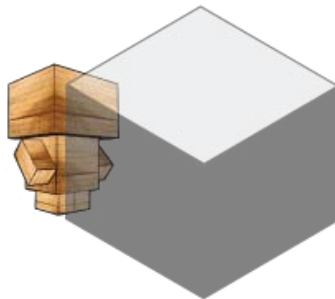
Plan View



Object you cannot interact with

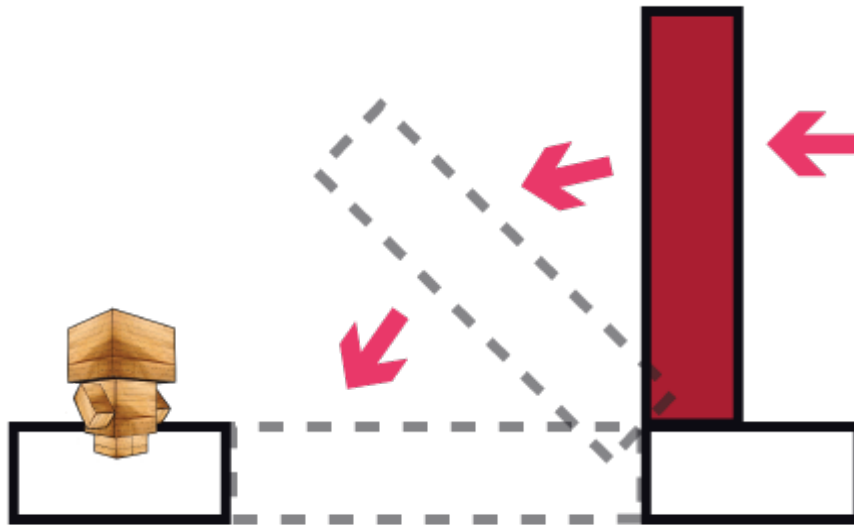


Object you can interact with

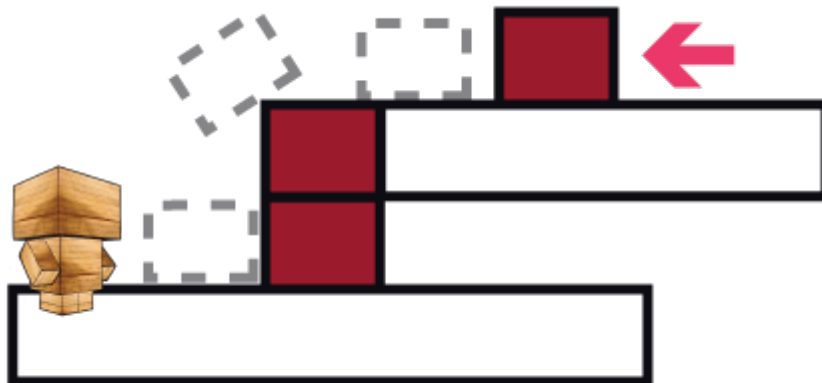


Object becomes translucent as the player walks behind it.

Player must use the appropriate Origami form to transport to various destinations in order to lead the boy to safety. Below are some examples of how simple puzzles work.



Player must transform into a crane in order to fly across and push the bridge over.



Player must transform into a frog in order to jump up and across and pushes one of the blocks over.

Music Scores and Sound Effects

Overview

The world of ONO attempts to recreate the sounds of a modern Japanese city. When the player is transported to the origami folding portions of the game, they will experience a dynamic shift in the sounds. This will present the audio team with the challenge of creating two unique audio landscapes that help the player navigate and solve problems within the gameplay environments.

Sound Design

Ono is a game about peaceful interaction with obstacles to keep the main character away from harm. By Using light and playful effects and music, the sounds will reflect the main theme of preserving a child's innocence. The obstacles are not to be fear inducing, but rather somewhat appealing even though they will eventually lead to a lose condition of the game. The origami folding sequences within the game will be separate from the real world sounds, focusing on paper driven sound effects.

SFX

Main Character: Taro

Movement

Taro is a young boy that will have realistic sounds that match his size and age. Essential sounds would be walking at various speeds.

Speech

Taro's dialogue will depend on his current state (walking or interacting with obstacle). The sounds will not be in any known language, but rather a simulation of Japanese and baby talk.

Main Character: Atsuke

Movement

In spirit form, Atsuke's movement will be airy wisps. Depending on the current origami form, the sounds will be heavier but they will represent the sounds of paper form moving through a realistic environment.

Speech

Atsuke will not have any spoken dialogue, but the sounds will match his current form (spirit or origami). Atsuke will express his current state using a simulation of Japanese.

Obstacles & the Environments

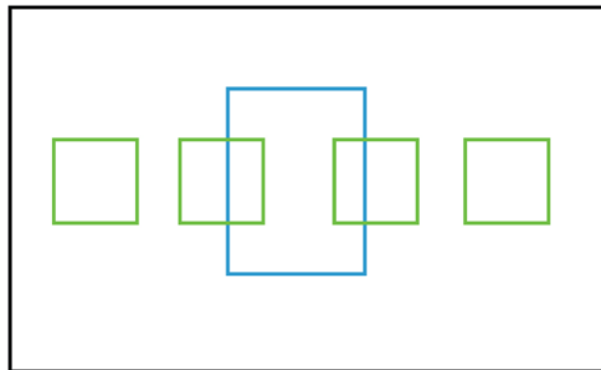
Obstacles in the game will only have Sound FX if they are people (groups or a single person). There are three major environments where Atsuke & Taro will progress through: Suburban Area, City Area, and the Park Area. Each area will be aimed to be an accurate representation of its virtual counterpart.

Music

The music will be piano driven with traditional Japanese influences. Some artists and composers that will be comparable to our desired sound are: Yoshida Brothers, Tchaikovsky, Chopin, & Joe Hishaishi.

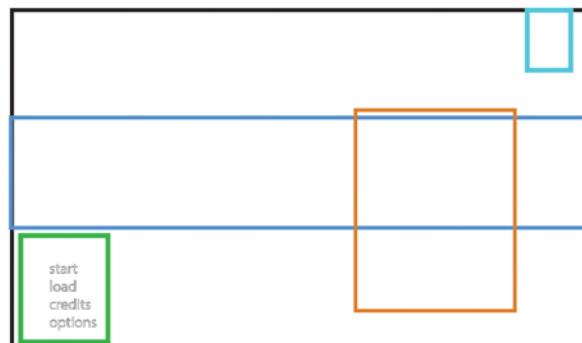
APPENDICES

Game Interface Diagrams



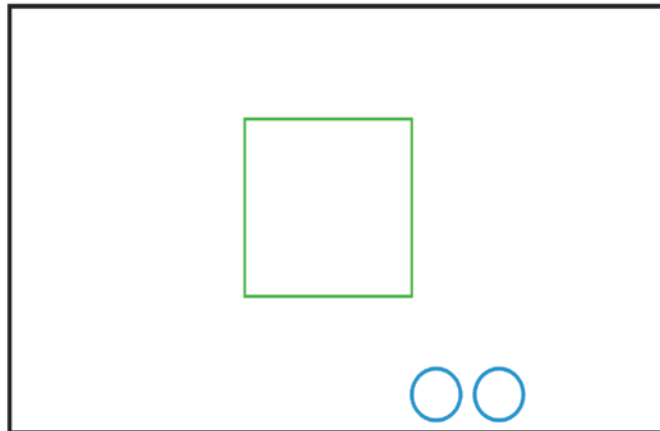
Screen 1 loading screen logo appears, flashes 3 times before vanishing. 4 different animations appear of figures being built. The front end effect will be on a looping animation cycle. The background would be black.

-  LOGO
-  ORIGAMI FIGURES - RHINO, CRANE, FROG AND BOAT
-  SCREEN "BLACK"



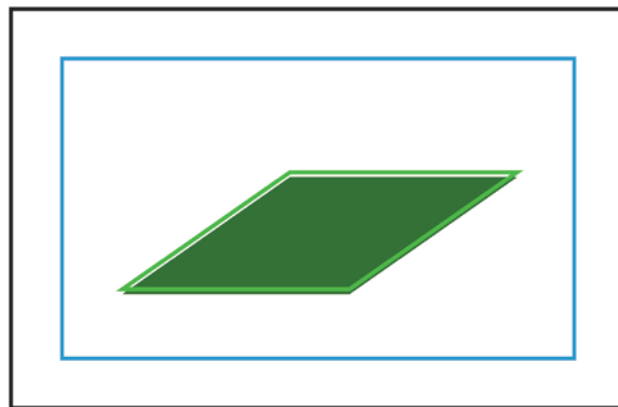
1st screen - world overview in the centre of the screen, player options in bottom left of the screen. Small game logo at top right of the screen, with an image of the main character in the rightmost part of the screen.

-  MENU BAR
-  CHARACTER IN PERSPECTIVE
-  VIEW OF THE WORLD
-  LOGO SMALL



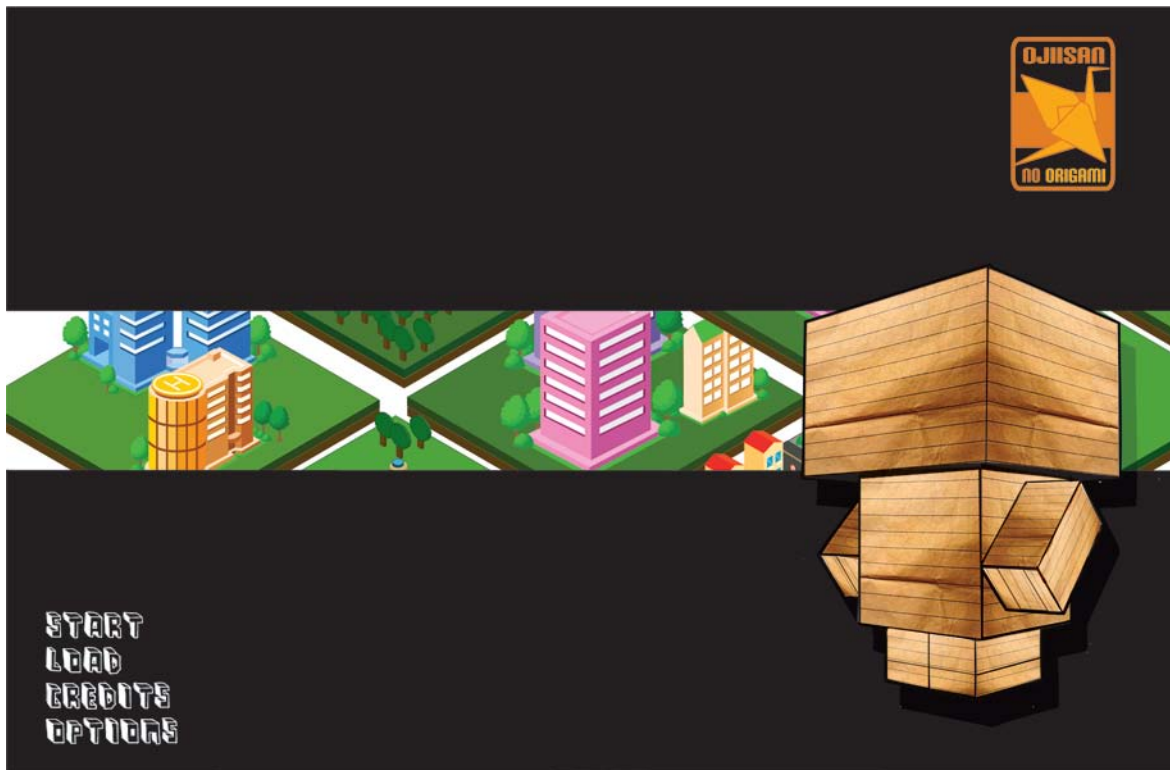
In in-game screen will have no HUD , save from some occasions (such as building origami shapes , slight visual cues). the pause menu will appear in the middle of the screen as a cardboard box that will move as the player makes selections.

- in pause game menu
- building origam commands check



In level selection screen Finalize 3d animation where the total world spins In the middle .Also when the player is on top of the level the color of the map will change .Outside of the mildle there is going to be a CARDBOARD texture .

- 3d level selection
- texture out side cardboard



Menu Screen Mock-up

Story

Sasuke Taro was 5 years old in 2003, when his parents were taken in an automobile accident. Taro was released into the care of his grandfather, Sasuke Atsuke, who lived with the family at the time. Each year, during the summer trimester break, Atsuke would take his grandson to Peace Memorial Park in Hiroshima to place a paper crane on the Children's Peace Monument.

However, in 2009, Atsuke passed away, and Taro was adopted by his aunt in North America. Transplanted to North America, Taro cannot visit Peace Memorial this July, and he spends his summer with his cousins, adapting to the North American way of life, the English language, and the preparations he must make to enter school in September.

In Japanese culture, the Obon festival takes place in August for 3 days; a festival in which the ancestors are said to revisit the household, and watch over their loved ones. During this time, Atsuke is determined to visit his grandson festival, where lanterns are floated down a river to signal the return of the ancestors to their peace in the afterlife.

Taking on the role of Atsuke, the player will travel environments to find his grandson, by using his knowledge of origami to create vessels for himself to navigate the levels, and solve puzzles. Once he has found Taro, he will reunite with him in North America, and bring him one last paper crane before the Toro Nagashi him one last time, and deliver himself as a paper crane, to be sent off during Toro Nagashi, so that he can remind his grandson of not only their shared, personal traditions, but of the love of his people for peace and their hope for a peaceful world.

Competitive Analysis

Game Title	Competition	Our Answer
A Boy and His Blob (Wii)	• Side-kick used to traverse environment • Cartoonish art style • Problem solving elements	• No side-kick, you become origami creation • Stir up wonder of playing with paper • Solve puzzles to direct your grandson to the goal
Little Big Planet (PSP)	• Micro-realistic environments • Level editor • Customizable main character	• Real world environments • Environment modification • Encourages creativity through interacting with environment
Scribblenauts (NDS)	• Scribble art style • Create using dictionary • Problem solving with platforming elements	• Storybook art style • Create using origami patterns • Problem solving using environmental elements

Research/Resource

Children's Peace Monument Studies

<http://www.city.hiroshima.jp/shimin/heiwa/crane.html> (study on Children's Peace Monument/Paper Crane tradition)

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Children%27s_Peace_Monument (study on Children's Peace Monument/Sister Statue in North America)

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sadako_Sasaki (study on dedication to Sadako Sasaki/dedication and history of Monument)

Origami

<http://www.origami-club.com/en/> (study on actual creation of shapes)

<http://www.paperfolding.com/history/> (study on history of Origami, including links to historical essays)

Neil Baylen (group's Audio Engineer, has a lifetime of experience in the art of origami)

Geography

<http://gojapan.about.com/cs/chuburegion4/a/ninja.htm> (namedrop of Hikone, village in Shiga prefecture.

A tip of the hat to those who know Hikone as home to the Koga Ninja Clan, and something to think about in regards to how grandfather is so spry!)

Character Studies

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sarutobi_Sasuke (origin of the family name 'Sasuke' – another tip of the hat to those who wish to look deeper into grandfathers' life. More an Easter Egg)

<http://www.babynameshq.com/name/Taro> (translation of 'Taro', meaning 'Firstborn Male'. Symbolic for cultural importance of grandson in game as first and last male of the fathers' line, thus his elevated importance on a Japanese cultural level)

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Isshin_Tasuke (origin of grandfathers' personal name, 'Atsuke'. A play on 'Tasuke', who is a well-loved, fictional personality in Japanese culture. Known as a performer, an assistant to samurai, and an all-around everyman for the Japanese people)

Behavioral Activity

Being a new father myself, I drew on the kind of things that I would be concerned about my child doing. If I was able to be the archetypal 'angel on the shoulder', I tried to imagine what I would do to not only keep her safe, but make sure that she developed into a socially responsible 'good person', in my own eyes (Gordon Cooper)

Media

<http://www.imdb.com/name/nm0594503/> (Hayao Miyazaki - writer/director – story inspiration)

<http://www.imdb.com/title/tt0457430/> (Pan's Labyrinth – film – story/myth inspiration)

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/A_Wild_Ride_Through_the_Night (A Wild Ride Through the Night – book – study on established work being altered through modern thought and artistic license)



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Alexi Nijathaworn, Cinematic/Level Design gd15alexi@vfs.com